Local Time

When the sun is overhead on a particular line of longitude, it is 12 noon at all the places located on that line of longitude. This is called local time.

The Sun is overhead on a line of longitude only once in a day. So the local time differs for every line of longitude.

When the Sun is overhead the Greenwich Meridian at 12 noon, it is the local time of that place. The world time is calculated by this standard line of longitude. It is known as the **Greenwich Mean Time (GMT).**

For example, if the time is 12 noon at Greenwich Meridian, it is **12:04 p.m.** at 1°E line of longitude and **11:56 a.m.** at 1°W line of longitude. So, as one moves towards the east from any meridian the time increases. And if one moves towards the west from any meridian, time decreases.

DO YOU KNOW?

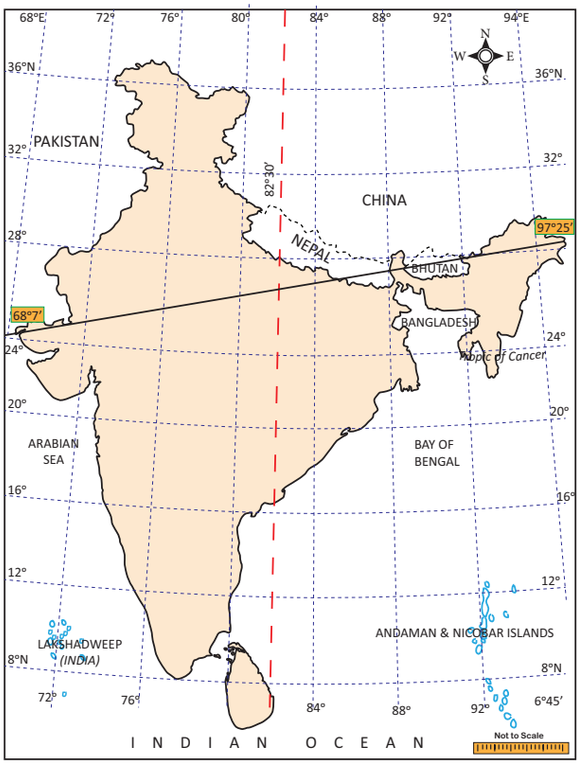
1. The word meridian is derived from the Latin word **'Meridianus'.** It means mid day. **(Medius – Middle, dies – day)**. So, meridian means the position of the Sun found overhead at a place at noon.
2. **a.m**. means 'anti Meridiem' **(anti – before)** – Before Noon.
3. **p.m**. means 'post Meridiem' **(Post – after/later)** – After noon.

Standard Time

Local time is calculated when the sun is overhead at noon. Many lines of longitude may pass through a country. Countries may or may not observe a common time. The standard time of a country or a part of it is calculated keeping a particular meridian as a standard one.

The meridians are selected in multiples of 15° or 7 ½°. It is done in such a way that the variation of standard time from the Greenwich is expressed either as 1 hour or ½ an hour.

Indian Standard Time



INDIAN STANDARD MERIDIAN

The longitudinal extent of India is from 68°7′ E to 97°25′ E. As many as twenty nine lines of longitude pass through India. Having 29 standard time is not logical. Hence 82½° E line of longitude is observed as the Prime Meridian to calculate the Indian Standard Time **(IST)**.

DO YOU KNOW?

The 82½° E line of longitude passes through **Mirzapur** near **Allahabad in Uttar Pradesh**. This is located at an equal distance from **Ghuar Mota** in **Gujarat** and **Kibithu** in **Arunachal Pradesh**.

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